

hand acknowledges and respects the existence of Windows on a machine and adds it to its boot menu.

To install Ubuntu on a machine without any operating systems, follow the regular procedure: insert the boot media (CD/DVD/USB drive) and boot the computer with it. You'll eventually arrive at the Ubuntu desktop, which, as we've already said, is very much usable as a complete system in itself. Before beginning the installation, take a backup, so that our installation is beneficial and not harmful to us. On the desktop you'll find a shortcut to the installer (it's called ubiquity). Simply double-click it and the installer will pop up asking questions (we'll call them steps to install Ubuntu):

Step 1: Choose your language. Since you're reading this, we assume you'd choose 'English' on that screen and press the 'Forward' button.

Step 2: On the next screen, ubiquity will recommend system requirements and tell you whether your system meets them all or not. It basically shows you the following requirements:

- ▶ 4.4 GB disk space – This is perhaps the only stringent requirement by Ubuntu. You should make sure that your hard disk has at least that much space. Of course the bigger, the better.
- ▶ Is connected to power source – This is not a very hardcore requirement. All Ubuntu wants to say here is: "please ensure power supply is not turned off when installing".
- ▶ Is connected to internet – Although this too is not a necessity, Ubuntu could use your internet connection to download updates and extra media codecs (both are options provided on the same screen) over the internet. This will ensure that your OS is brand new and updated when installation finally finishes.

Just make sure that Ubuntu is ready to be installed and press the 'Forward' button again to go to next step.

Step 3: In the next step, ubiquity will offer you two options: "Erase entire disk and install Ubuntu" and "Something else". Unless you have files which you'd like to have on disk, go with the first option. It tells Ubuntu to utilise the complete disk space and decide what's best for your system. Ubuntu will create its own root (/) partition, a swap partition and install itself on the '/' partition.